



CROSS-BORDER PAYMENT COMPLIANCE GUIDE

Avoid Fund Freezes. Build Secure Payment Systems.

A Practical Handbook for Digital Product Sellers
Using Stripe / PayPal / Gumroad

- ☐ Platform Risk Triggers & Red Lines
- ☐ Multi-Channel Payment Architecture
- ☐ VAT & Sales Tax Compliance
- ☐ Appeal Templates & Checklists
- ☐ Real Case Studies from Cross-Border Sellers

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By Senli • Version 1.0 • June 2026

CPSC eFiling New Rules Practical Manual

A Step-by-Step Guide for Cross-Border Sellers:
Complete Electronic Filing Before July 8, 2026

Version 1.0 · June 2026

Based on CPSC Official Announcements + CBP Requirements

■ CRITICAL DEADLINE

July 8, 2026 — Mandatory CPSC eFiling begins.

All CPSC-regulated products imported into the US must submit electronic certificate data through the ACE system.

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Chapter 1: Is Your Product Under CPSC Jurisdiction?

1.1 Quick Scope Checklist

Does your product fall under CPSC jurisdiction? Answer these 3 questions:

#	Question	If YES →
1	Is this a consumer product (sold to individuals, not businesses)?	→ Under CPSC jurisdiction
2	Is it intended for children 12 or under (toys, baby gear, children's clothing)?	→ Needs CPC certificate

3	Is it a general product (electronics, furniture, lighting, tools, adult clothing)?	→ Needs GCC certificate
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If you answered YES to Question 1, your product is under CPSC jurisdiction and must be electronically filed via ACE starting July 8, 2026.

■ Critical Deadline: July 8, 2026 After this date, ALL CPSC-regulated products imported into the US MUST submit electronic certificate data through the ACE system. Without it: cargo detention, port storage fees, possible return or destruction.

1.2 Product Categories Under CPSC Jurisdiction

CPSC regulates approximately 10,000 consumer product types across these major categories:

Category A: Children's Products (Need CPC Certificate)

Definition: A "children's product" is any product **primarily designed or intended** for children 12 years of age or younger. If your product packaging, marketing, or design targets kids, it's a children's product.

Category B: General Use Products (Need GCC Certificate)

Definition: A "general use product" is any consumer product NOT primarily designed for children 12 or under. These require a General Certificate of Conformity (GCC), not a CPC.

1.3 Products NOT Under CPSC Jurisdiction

These product categories are explicitly excluded from CPSC regulation:

■ Grey Area Warning: Some products overlap jurisdictions. For example: - A **baby bottle** is regulated by CPSC (safety) AND FDA (food contact) - A **kids' tablet computer** needs CPSC (CPC) AND FCC (radio emissions) - A **cosmetic product for children** falls under FDA, NOT CPSC

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If your product is in a grey area, check both regulators. Better safe than sorry.

1.4 How to Confirm: 3 Ways to Verify

If you're not sure whether your product is under CPSC jurisdiction:

Method 1: CPSC Product Database Search

Visit [cpsc.gov](https://www.cpsc.gov) and search for your product category. The CPSC website lists all regulated product types with specific rule citations.

Method 2: Ask Your Freight Forwarder

Forwarders who regularly ship to the US know which products require CPSC compliance. Ask them directly: *"Does this HTS code require CPSC certificate data in ACE?"*

Method 3: Check with Your Testing Lab

Reputable testing labs (SGS, TÜV, Intertek, BV) can confirm whether your product falls under CPSC jurisdiction and which certificate type you need (CPC or GCC).

****■ Pro Tip**:** *If you're selling on Amazon US, check your product listing category. Amazon has pre-mapped CPSC requirements for most categories. If Amazon asks for a CPC or GCC during listing creation, your product IS under CPSC jurisdiction.*

1.5 CPC vs GCC: Quick Decision Tree

Is your product primarily for children ≤12 years old? ■ ■■■ YES → You need CPC (Children's Product Certificate) ■ ■ ■ ■■■ Must be tested by CPSC-accepted third-party lab ■ ■■■ Must include 7 specific data elements ■ ■■■ Must accompany every shipment ■ ■■■ NO → Is it a consumer product (not alcohol/tobacco/vehicle/drug/device)? ■ ■■■ YES → You need GCC (General Certificate of Conformity) ■ ■ ■ ■■■ May be self-certified (based on your own test results) ■ ■■■ Must include product identification and applicable rules ■ ■■■ Must accompany every shipment ■ ■■■ NO → Not under CPSC jurisdiction (Check other regulators: FDA, USDA, NHTSA, etc.)

1.6 Real-World Examples

Product	Jurisdiction	Certificate Needed	Why
Children's plush toy	CPSC	CPC	Primarily for children ≤12
Adult cotton t-shirt	CPSC	GCC	General use product, flammability standard applies
Kids' electric scooter	CPSC + CPSC eFiling	CPC	Children's product with electronic components
Baby formula	FDA (NOT CPSC)	None for CPSC	Food product, FDA-regulated
Children's bicycle	CPSC	CPC + FCC (if electronic)	Children's product + potential radio emissions
Wireless mouse (adult)	CPSC + FCC	GCC + FCC SDOC	General use product + electronic device

Kids' art crayons	CPSC + FDA (labeling)	CPC	Children's product, art material standard applies
Adult leather handbag	CPSC (borderline)	Possibly GCC	Consumer product, check specific standards
Car seat for adults	NHTSA (NOT CPSC)	None for CPSC	Motor vehicle accessory
Kids' car seat	CPSC + NHTSA	CPC	Both CPSC (product safety) and NHTSA (vehicle)

****■ Summary****: Before you do anything else, confirm whether your product is under CPSC jurisdiction. This is the foundation of everything that follows. If your product is NOT under CPSC jurisdiction, you don't need this manual. If it IS, proceed to Chapter 2.

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****Time estimate****: 15 minutes to confirm jurisdiction. ****Next step****: Once confirmed, move to Chapter 2 to prepare your 7 required documents.

Chapter 2: Preparation — 7 Documents You Need

2.1 The 7-Document Checklist

Before you can file through ACE, you need these 7 items ready. Each one is explained below with:

- What it is
- Where to get it
- Estimated time
- Common mistakes

#	Document	Purpose	Where to Get	Est. Time
1	Product Identification Sheet	What exactly are you shipping?	You create it	30 min
2	Applicable Safety Rules List	Which CPSC rules apply?	CPSC website + lab	1 hour
3	Manufacturing Location Proof	Where was it made?	Factory	1 day

4	Testing Date & Location Records	When and where was it tested?	Testing lab	N/A (already done)
5	Certificate of Compliance (CPC/GCC)	The actual compliance certificate	You create it (based on lab test)	1 hour
6	Lab Accreditation Proof	Is the lab CPSC-accepted?	Lab website or CPSC database	15 min
7	US Importer/Manufacturer Info	Who is legally responsible?	You (or your agent)	30 min

2.2 Detailed Breakdown of Each Document

Document 1: Product Identification Sheet

What: A clear description of your product including:

- Product name (English)
- Product model/SKU number
- Product images (front, back, side views)
- Target age range (if applicable)
- Material composition
- Packaging description

Common Mistake: Vague product descriptions like "kids toy" or "electronic gadget." Be specific: "Plush teddy bear, 30cm, polyester, ASTM F963 compliant, ages 3+."

Document 2: Applicable Safety Rules List

What: A list of EVERY CPSC safety rule that applies to your product. For children's products, this typically includes:

- CPSIA (lead content, phthalates)
- ASTM F963 (toy safety)
- Any product-specific rule (e.g., 16 CFR Part 1218 for cribs)

For general products, this may include:

- 16 CFR Part 1610 (flammability of clothing)
- Product-specific standards

How to Find: Search [cpsc.gov](https://www.cpsc.gov) for your product category, or ask your testing lab.

Document 3: Manufacturing Location Proof

What: Official documentation showing where your product was manufactured, including:

- Factory name
- Factory address (city, province, country)
- Production date (month and year minimum)

How to Get: Request from your factory. They should provide a manufacturing declaration letter on company letterhead.

Document 4: Testing Date & Location Records

What: The test report from your CPSC-accepted third-party laboratory, including:

- Test date(s)
- Test location
- Test methods used
- Test results (pass/fail for each applicable standard)

Note: This should already exist if you've been selling on Amazon or to US retailers. If not, you need to get your product tested NOW.

Document 5: Certificate of Compliance (CPC or GCC)

What: The actual certificate document. This is NOT issued by any government agency — YOU create it based on your lab test results.

For CPC (Children's Product Certificate), must include:

1. Product identification
2. All applicable children's product safety rules cited
3. Contact information for the US importer or domestic manufacturer who is issuing the certificate
4. Address and telephone number of the domestic manufacturer or importer
5. Date and place of manufacture
6. Date and place of testing
7. Information about the third-party lab that conducted the testing (name, address, phone, CPSC acceptance number)

For GCC (General Certificate of Conformity), must include:

1. Product identification
2. Description of the applicable consumer product safety rules

3. Identification of any children's products for which the certificate is provided (if applicable)
4. Manufacturer or importer name and contact information
5. Date and place of testing
6. Testing body information

Document 6: Lab Accreditation Proof

What: Evidence that your testing lab is accepted by CPSC. Check the CPSC Third-Party Laboratory Acceptance Database at [\[cpsc.gov/labsearch\]\(https://www.cpsc.gov/s3fs-public/Third-Party-Lab-Acceptance-List.pdf\)](https://www.cpsc.gov/s3fs-public/Third-Party-Lab-Acceptance-List.pdf).

How to Verify: Search for your lab's name in the database. If it's listed, you're good. If not, find a CPSC-accepted lab immediately.

Document 7: US Importer/Manufacturer Info

What: Legal entity information for the party responsible for compliance:

- Company name
- Physical address (not a P.O. Box)
- Phone number
- Email address
- EIN/Tax ID (if applicable)

Note: If you're a Chinese manufacturer selling directly, you ARE the manufacturer. If you're an Amazon seller importing from China, you ARE the importer. Either way, you're responsible.

2.3 Timeline: When to Start

****■ If you're starting from zero**:** You need to get your product tested *FIRST*. Testing takes 2-4 weeks. Then you create the certificate. Then you file through ACE. Total minimum time: 4-6 weeks.

Chapter 3: ACE System Filing — Complete Walkthrough

3.1 What Is ACE?

ACE (Automated Commercial Environment) is CBP's (U.S. Customs and Border Protection) system for processing commercial import data. Starting July 8, 2026, CPSC certificate data must be submitted through ACE as part of the PGA (Partner Government Agency) Message Set.

*****Key Point**:*** *You don't file directly through ACE yourself. Your freight forwarder or customs broker files on your behalf. BUT you MUST provide them with the correct data elements.*

3.2 The 7 ACE Data Elements for CPSC eFiling

These are the EXACT data fields you need to provide to your forwarder/broker:

*****Critical**:*** *These 7 data elements map DIRECTLY to the information in your CPC/GCC certificate. Make sure they match exactly.*

3.3 Filing Process: Step by Step

Step 1: Confirm Your ACE Account Status

Your freight forwarder or customs broker should already have an ACE account. If they don't, they can't file for you. Confirm this BEFORE July 8.

Step 2: Prepare Your Data Elements

Fill in the 7 data elements listed above. Use the same information that appears in your CPC/GCC certificate.

Step 3: Submit to Your Forwarder/Broker

Provide the data elements to your forwarder or broker at least 5 business days before your shipment arrives at a US port.

Step 4: Forwarder Files Through ACE

Your forwarder enters the data into ACE as a CPSC PGA Message Set. This happens automatically during customs clearance.

Step 5: Receive Confirmation

CBP will return a confirmation that the CPSC data was received and matched to your shipment. Keep this confirmation for your records.

3.4 Common Filing Rejection Reasons

Reason	How to Fix
Missing data element	Double-check all 7 elements are provided
Mismatched product ID	Ensure Product ID in filing matches your CPC/GCC exactly
Expired test report	Tests must be current. If older than 1-2 years, re-test
Lab not CPSC-accepted	Verify your lab is in the CPSC database
Wrong certificate type	CPC for children's products, GCC for general products
Incomplete rule citation	List ALL applicable rules, not just some

3.5 What Happens After Successful Filing

Benefits

- Lower risk score: CBP assigns lower risk scores to shipments with valid CPSC eFiling data
- Fewer physical inspections: Reduced chance of cargo being pulled for manual examination
- Faster clearance: Shipment moves through customs more quickly
- Compliance record: Builds a positive compliance history for future shipments

Ongoing Obligations

- Every shipment: You must file eFiling data for EVERY shipment going forward
 - Updates: If your product, testing, or certificate changes, update your ACE data accordingly
 - Record retention: Keep all filing records for at least 5 years
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Chapter 4: Communication Templates — Agents & Labs

4.1 Scenario 1: You Already Have a Testing Lab

Goal: Get your lab to provide the 7 ACE data elements in the correct format.

Email Template:

Subject: CPSC eFiling Data Request – [Product Name/SKU] – Deadline July 8, 2026 Dear [Lab Contact Name], I hope this email finds you well. We are preparing for the mandatory CPSC eFiling

requirement that takes effect on July 8, 2026. For our product [Product Name, SKU: XXX], we need the following 7 data elements from your testing records to complete our ACE filing: 1. Certificate Type: [CPC or GCC] 2. Product ID: [Your SKU or product identifier] 3. Applicable Rules: [List all CPSC rules your test covered] 4. Manufacturing Date: [Month/Year your product was made] 5. Manufacturing Location: [City, Province, Country] 6. Testing Date & Location: [Date and lab address] 7. Responsible Party: [Your company name, address, contact] Could you please confirm that items 3 and 6 above match your test report exactly? We need this information by [date, at least 2 weeks before shipment]. Thank you for your assistance. Best regards, [Your Name] [Your Company] [Phone] [Email]

4.2 Scenario 2: You DON'T Have a Testing Lab Yet

Goal: Find a CPSC-accepted lab and get your product tested ASAP.

Email Template:

Subject: Urgent: CPSC Testing Required – [Product Name/SKU] – Deadline July 8, 2026 Dear [Lab Name], I am looking for CPSC-accepted third-party testing for the following product: Product: [Product Name and Description] Category: [Children's Product / General Use Product] Target Age: [If children's product, specify age range] Material: [Materials used] Quantity: [Approximate units per shipment] I need the following: 1. Testing quote (CPC or GCC as applicable) 2. Estimated turnaround time 3. Confirmation that your lab is currently CPSC-accepted 4. List of CPSC rules your testing will cover Our deadline is July 8, 2026 (mandatory CPSC eFiling). Can you complete testing and provide the certificate before this date? Please respond ASAP as I need to arrange production/shipping accordingly. Best regards, [Your Name] [Your Company] [Phone] [Email]

4.3 Scenario 3: Your Freight Forwarder Doesn't Know About CPSC eFiling

Goal: Inform your forwarder and ensure they can file through ACE.

Email Template:

Subject: URGENT: CPSC eFiling Required for All Shipments After July 8, 2026 Dear [Forwarder Contact Name], Starting July 8, 2026, the US CPSC requires ALL CPSC-regulated products to submit electronic certificate data through the ACE (Automated Commercial Environment) system. For our upcoming shipment [Shipment Reference/BL Number], I will need you to file CPSC eFiling data on our behalf. Please confirm: 1. Does your company have an ACE account with CPSC PGA access? 2. Can you accept CPSC certificate data from us and file it through ACE? 3. What is your process for receiving this data? (Email? Portal?) 4. How many business days in advance do you need the data before cargo arrival? If you are NOT able to file CPSC eFiling data, please let me know IMMEDIATELY so I can arrange an alternative customs broker. Thank you, [Your Name] [Your Company] [Phone] [Email]

4.4 Phone Call Talking Points

If you need to call your lab or forwarder, here are the key points:

To the Lab:

- "Does your lab appear in the current CPSC Third-Party Laboratory Acceptance Database?"
- "Can you provide a certificate that includes all 7 ACE data elements?"
- "What is your current turnaround time for [your product category] testing?"

To the Forwarder:

- "Can you file CPSC eFiling data through ACE for my shipments?"
 - "How many days before cargo arrival do you need the data?"
 - "What format do you need the data in?"
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Chapter 5: Typical Scenarios and Responses

Scenario 1: Children's Toys — Successful Filing Timeline

Background: A Shenzhen-based toy exporter ships plush toys to a US buyer.

Timeline:

Day	Action	Status
Day 1	Confirm product is under CPSC (it's a children's toy → needs CPC)	■ Done
Day 2	Send product to SGS for testing (ASTM F963 + CPSIA)	■ Done
Day 8	Test results received (PASS)	■ Done
Day 9	Create CPC certificate using test report data	■ Done
Day 10	Send 7 ACE data elements to forwarder	■ Done
Day 15	Cargo departs Shenzhen	■ Done
Day 22	Cargo arrives LA port, ACE filing processed	■ Done

Day 23	Cargo cleared, no physical inspection	■ Done
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Key Success Factors:

- Started testing early (2 weeks before shipment)
 - Used a CPSC-accepted lab (SGS)
 - Provided forwarder with data 7+ days before arrival
 - All 7 ACE data elements matched the CPC certificate exactly
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Scenario 2: Electronics — Incomplete Data Causes Rejection

Background: A Guangzhou electronics exporter ships LED desk lamps (general use product → needs GCC).

Problem: The exporter's GCC certificate listed only "16 CFR Part 1610" (flammability) but missed "16 CFR Part 1263" (unsafe bed furnishings, if applicable) and other relevant standards.

Result: CBP flagged the shipment for incomplete rule citation. Cargo held at port for 5 days. Storage fees: ~\$800.

Lessons Learned:

1. List ALL applicable rules, not just the obvious ones
2. Ask your testing lab for the complete rules list
3. Cross-reference with CPSC's product database before filing

Corrected Process:

1. Check CPSC database for ALL rules applicable to LED lamps
 2. Include: flammability (16 CFR Part 1610), electrical safety (if applicable), lead content (CPSIA)
 3. File complete data through ACE
-

Scenario 3: Forwarder Uncooperative — Self-Filing Solution

Background: A small Amazon seller in Yiwu finds that their usual forwarder doesn't have ACE access.

Solution:

1. Hire a US-based customs broker (\$150-300 per filing)
2. Provide the broker with CPC/GCC certificate and 7 data elements

3. Broker files through ACE on your behalf
4. Total cost increase: ~\$200 per shipment (worth avoiding port delays)

Alternative: Find a forwarder who DOES have ACE access. Many larger forwarders (DHL, FedEx Trade Networks, Kuehne+Nagel) already do.

Scenario 4: July 6 Start — Emergency Response

Background: It's July 6, 2026. You just realized your shipment needs CPSC eFiling, but you haven't prepared anything.

Emergency Plan:

****Reality Check**:** *If you haven't had your product tested, you CANNOT complete this process in time. Testing takes 2-4 weeks minimum. In this case, you may need to delay shipment or explore emergency testing options (some labs offer rush service for 2x-3x price).*

Scenario 5: Wrong Certificate Filed — Correction Process

Background: A seller filed GCC (general product) for a children's product that actually requires CPC.

Problem: CBP detected the mismatch during risk screening. Shipment flagged for compliance review.

Correction Process:

1. Stop the shipment at the port (don't let it clear)
2. Immediately create the correct CPC certificate based on lab test results
3. Contact your customs broker to amend the ACE filing
4. Submit corrected data with explanation
5. Expect a 3-7 day delay while CBP reviews the correction

Prevention: Always double-check: children's product = CPC, not GCC. Use the decision tree in Chapter 1.

Chapter 6: Last-Minute Contingency Plans

6.1 Option A: Apply for Extension

When to use: You cannot complete testing or filing before July 8.

Steps:

1. Contact your forwarder/broker immediately
2. Ask if CBP offers any grace period or extension for eFiling
3. If available: submit a provisional filing with available data
4. Complete full filing within the extension period

Reality: Extensions are NOT guaranteed. CBP has been firm about the July 8 deadline. Do not rely on this option.

6.2 Option B: Batch Filing

When to use: You have multiple shipments and can't file each one individually.

Approach:

1. Consolidate all pending shipments into one batch
2. Provide the forwarder with a consolidated data sheet
3. Request batch filing through ACE

Benefit: Saves time and reduces administrative burden.

Risk: If ONE shipment in the batch has incorrect data, the entire batch may be held.

6.3 Option C: Alternative Routing

When to use: Your primary port of entry doesn't support CPSC eFiling.

Options:

1. Route cargo through a different US port that has CPSC eFiling capability
 2. Use a different forwarder/broker that supports ACE filing
 3. Consider air freight for urgent shipments (faster clearance, but more expensive)
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6.4 If You Can't Meet the July 8 Deadline

Worst-case scenario: You have a shipment arriving after July 8 without CPSC eFiling data.

Possible outcomes:

- Best case: Cargo held at port for 1-3 days while you rush the filing
- Likely case: Cargo held for 5-10 days, incurring storage fees (\$200-500/day)
- Worst case: Cargo returned to origin or destroyed

Cost comparison:

- Getting tested NOW: ~\$500-3,000 (depending on product)
- Port storage for 7 days: ~\$1,400-3,500
- Lost sales from delayed shipment: Unknown, potentially much higher

*****Bottom line**:*** *It is ALWAYS cheaper to prepare NOW than to deal with the consequences after July 8.*

Chapter 7: Appendix — 7 Downloadable Assets

Asset A: Product Classification Checklist (PDF)

A printable checkbox list to determine if your product is under CPSC jurisdiction and whether you need CPC or GCC.

Asset B: 7-Document Preparation Tracker (Excel)

Track the status of each of the 7 required documents. Shows: document name, status (ready/not ready), responsible party, deadline, and notes.

Asset C: ACE Data Elements Reference Card (PDF)

A quick-reference card showing the 7 ACE data elements with examples. Print this and keep it near your desk when preparing filings.

Asset D: CPC Certificate Template (Word)

A ready-to-use CPC certificate template. Fill in your product information and it will auto-populate all 7 required data elements.

Asset E: GCC Certificate Template (Word)

A ready-to-use GCC certificate template for general use products.

Asset F: Lab Verification Checklist (PDF)

Checklist to verify that your testing lab is CPSC-accepted. Includes links to the CPSC database and steps for verification.

Asset G: Emergency Response Flowchart (PDF)

Printable flowchart for the "July 6 Emergency" scenario. Shows step-by-step decisions and actions.

Glossary

- ACE: Automated Commercial Environment — CBP's system for processing import data
 - CBP: U.S. Customs and Border Protection
 - CPC: Children's Product Certificate — required for products primarily for children ≤ 12
 - CPSC: U.S. Consumer Product Safety Commission
 - GCC: General Certificate of Conformity — required for general use products
 - PGA: Partner Government Agency — agencies other than CBP that have regulatory authority over imports
 - HTS: Harmonized Tariff Schedule — the system for classifying imported products
 - ASTM F963: The US toy safety standard (physical, mechanical, flammability)
 - CPSIA: Consumer Product Safety Improvement Act — US law requiring CPC for children's products
 - NRTL: Nationally Recognized Testing Laboratory — for FCC testing (often combined with CPSC)
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*****Disclaimer**:** This manual is compiled from publicly available information including CPSC announcements, CBP documentation, and industry best practices for reference only. CPSC policies may change at any time. Please refer to the latest official policies at [cpsc.gov](https://www.cpsc.gov). This guide does not constitute*

legal advice. For specific questions, please consult a qualified attorney or compliance professional.

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*****Update Commitment****: If CPSC eFiling policies change within 30 days of the July 8, 2026 mandatory implementation date, purchasers will receive a free updated version of this manual.*